

Unit 6: Practical Skills in Physics II

IA2 compulsory unit

Externally assessed

6.1 Unit description

Introduction

Students are expected to further develop the experimental skills they acquired in Units 1 and 2.

Students are expected to develop these skills, and a knowledge and understanding of experimental techniques, by carrying out a range of practical experiments and investigations while they study Units 4 and 5.

This unit will assess students' knowledge and understanding of experimental procedures and techniques that were developed when they conducted these experiments.

Development of practical skills, knowledge and understanding

Students should carry out a variety of practical work during the IA2 course to develop their practical skills.

In order to prepare students for the assessment of this unit, centres should give students opportunities to plan experiments, implement their plans, collect data, analyse their data and draw conclusions.

Experiments should cover a range of different topic areas and use a variety of practical techniques.

Students should gain experience of using log graphs to determine the relationship between two variables. The graphs do not always need to be obtained for variables that are related by the exponential function.

For example, students could investigate how the pressure of a fixed mass of gas varies with its volume at constant temperature and plot an appropriate log/log graph to determine the relationship between the pressure and volume of the gas.
